Syllabus & objectives

By Laura Elizabeth Hand

Use for a syllabus, calendar, or grading plan.

Choose one rating per question. Leave an item blank if you need to review it later. Add notes where useful and save a copy after filling.

What did you review? Include the version.

Audience, format, or test setup

Reviewer (optional)

Review date (optional)

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01 / Clear learning objectives

Do the objectives say what learners will be able to do?

Look for actions you can see in learner work, such as explain, build, compare, or justify.

Missing
No objectives, or only a list of topics.

Needs work
Uses words such as understand without saying what shows understanding.

Meets expectations
Names an observable action at the right level.

Strong
Gives the situation or criteria learners can use to check their work.

Does not apply - give a reason in Notes.

Rating

Choose a rating

Notes or reason (optional)

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02 / Objectives and assignments

Can learners see which assignments show each objective?

Match the main objectives to assignments or practice checks and their criteria.

Missing
No links between objectives and work.

Needs work
Some objectives lack a matching task.

Meets expectations
Every major objective has a task that checks it.

Strong
Learners can also trace the related practice, criteria, and revision.

Does not apply - give a reason in Notes.

Rating

Choose a rating

Notes or reason (optional)

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03 / Schedule and workload

Can learners see what to do and when they have time to revise?

Check dates, preparation, major deadlines, and feedback windows.

Missing
Essential dates are missing.

Needs work
Dates exist but checkpoints or workload are unclear.

Meets expectations
Practice, feedback, and due dates fit together.

Strong
Time estimates and milestones help learners plan the busiest weeks.

Does not apply - give a reason in Notes.

Rating

Choose a rating

Notes or reason (optional)

04 / Grading and feedback

Can learners tell how their work will be graded?

Check weights, submission instructions, criteria, and how feedback arrives.

Missing
Grading is unclear or absent.

Needs work
Rules or weights are incomplete or conflict.

Meets expectations
Weights add up and grading, submission, and feedback are clear.

Strong
A sample or worked example shows how the rules apply.

Does not apply - give a reason in Notes.

Rating

Choose a rating

Notes or reason (optional)

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05 / Participation and support

Can learners find what participation means and where to get help?

Look for attendance expectations, practical alternatives, and clear contact routes.

Missing
Expectations or help routes are missing.

Needs work
Policies are listed, but learners may not know how to get support.

Meets expectations
Expectations and support contacts are easy to find.

Strong
Alternatives and support steps work across delivery formats.

Does not apply - give a reason in Notes.

Rating

Choose a rating

Notes or reason (optional)

06 / Navigation and access

Can learners find and open the information they need?

Check links, headings, and whether the syllabus and course site agree.

Missing
Important information is hard to find or open.

Needs work
Navigation or consistency varies.

Meets expectations
Headings, links, and formats make key information easy to find.

Strong
A learner walkthrough confirms the information is usable.

Does not apply - give a reason in Notes.

Rating

Choose a rating

Notes or reason (optional)

Revision priorities

Sources and related tools

Curriculum Review Studio - Laura Elizabeth Hand

Curriculum and workshop QA resources

Teaching & Research Methods